

The Human-AI Partnership Framework

Where human judgment belongs

Recruit-to-Hire

PCF 7.2 — Acquire Talent — Value Stream Profile

This value stream comprises one APQC PCF process group: 7.2 Recruit, Source, and Select Employees — spanning 5 Level 3 processes and 24 Level 4 activities.

At the activity level, this value stream's work breaks down as 15 Transaction activities (rules-based processing suited to automation), 5 Knowledge activities (judgment, synthesis, and interpretation-driven work), 3 Decision activities (judgment-and-authority gates that stay human by design), and 1 Document activity (content generation). No Exception-pattern activity exists within this value stream.

At M3 (HITL Design Intent), the value stream's aggregate human-involvement ratio is 47%, down from a 70% undesigned baseline — a 23-point AI convergence opportunity.

L3 PROCESSES	L4 ACTIVITIES	M1 BASELINE H%	M3 DESIGN INTENT H%	Δ M1 → M3
5	24	70%	47%	-23%

KPIs

Business Impact Metric & Formula (where confirmed)	Source
Time-to-hire <i>Sum of 3 cycle-time stages: need-to-hire → requisition approval, approval → offer acceptance, acceptance → start date</i>	APQC OSB
Cost-per-hire <i>Total cost to perform "recruit, source, and select employees" ÷ Total number of new hires</i>	APQC OSB
Offer-acceptance rate	—
Quality-of-hire / early attrition <i>100% – new hire retention rate at 12 months (tracked by tier)</i>	APQC OSB

Design Narrative

Recruit-to-Hire, now scoped to candidate acquisition alone, keeps human judgment concentrated at two points: candidate selection itself (7.2.3, the interview and select/reject decision) and final hire commitment (7.2.4, offer negotiation) — both Accountable to Recruiter. Everything else in the value stream — requisition administration (7.2.1), sourcing-channel execution (7.2.2), applicant data management (7.2.5) — carries real AI-absorption opportunity at M3, reflected in the value stream's steepest single gap sitting in 7.2.4.1 (Draw up and make offer, Document-pattern, -32 points), with 7.2.5's entirely Transaction-pattern applicant-information work close behind at -25.

AI Capability Map

Pattern-type distribution across this value stream's activity units. H% figures are the pattern type's standard value at each maturity level, applied consistently across all PCF domains.

Decision <i>Judgment & Authority — gates that stay human by design</i> 3 L4 activities M1 92% → M3 80%	Knowledge <i>Synthesis & Interpretation — judgment-driven work</i> 5 L4 activities M1 85% → M3 65%	Document <i>Content Generation — drafting and communication</i> 1 L4 activities M1 72% → M3 40%	Transaction <i>Rules-Based Processing — suited to automation</i> 15 L4 activities M1 60% → M3 35%	Exception <i>Non-Standard Resolution — human-resolved by nature</i> 0 L4 activities <i>No activities of this pattern in this value stream</i>
---	---	--	--	--

Process Accountability

Process Accountability	Tier	L3 Processes	L4 Activities
HRBP Manager	Managerial	7.2.1	7
Recruiter	Operational	7.2.2, 7.2.3, 7.2.4	13
HRIS Analyst	Operational	7.2.5	4

Handoff Points

Recruit-to-Hire opens with HRBP Manager on requisition management (7.2.1), then hands to Recruiter for the full candidate lifecycle: sourcing (7.2.2), screening and selection (7.2.3), and new hire/offer management (7.2.4) — the value stream's largest single lane.

The funnel closes with HRIS Analyst, Accountable for applicant information management (7.2.5) — background checks, records, tracking, archiving — entirely Transaction-pattern, one of the value stream's largest AI-absorption opportunities (Δ -25 points).

Governed Decision Points

Every Decision/Exception-pattern activity in the value stream, including those embedded inside Mixed-labeled steps.

PCF	Decision	Authority	Impact	Escalates To	Trigger
7.2.1.3	Authorize a job requisition against budget and approved headcount plan	HRBP Manager, Finance	Financial — budget commitment	CHRO (Executive)	Requisition falls outside the approved headcount plan or requires cross-functional budget reallocation
7.2.3.4	Select and reject candidates; commit to a hire	Recruiter, Hiring Managers*	Financial + People — compensation commitment, team composition	CHRO (Executive)	Role is senior/leadership-level, or offer terms exceed standard compensation band
7.2.4.2	Negotiate final offer terms with candidate (embedded in Manage New Hire / Rehire)	Recruiter, Compensation & Benefits Manager	Financial — compensation exception	Director of Talent Acquisition (Managerial)	Negotiated terms exceed standard offer parameters — comp above band, signing bonus, relocation

© Timothy P. King 2026 · developed with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic)